



Privacy Policy

Effective date: 4 October 2026 · Last updated: 4 October 2026

This Privacy Policy explains how Designlynk (Pty) Ltd ("Designlynk", "we", "us") collects, uses, and protects personal information in connection with the Designlynk platform ("the Platform"), in accordance with the Protection of Personal Information Act, 2013 (POPIA).

1. Who We Are

Designlynk is the "responsible party" for personal information processed through the Platform, as defined in POPIA.

2. Our Information Officer

Our Information Officer is responsible for ensuring compliance with POPIA and can be contacted regarding any privacy question or request.

3. Information We Collect

- **Account information:** name, email address, phone number, and password;
- **Verification information:** qualifications, professional credentials, portfolio items, and identity documents submitted by Professionals for vetting;
- **Payment information:** processed and stored by Stripe on our behalf — Designlynk does not directly store full card or bank account details;
- **Engagement information:** project scope, messages, files, and deliverables exchanged between Clients and Professionals through the Platform;
- **Usage information:** log data, device information, and how the Platform is used, collected automatically;
- **Communications:** messages sent to Designlynk support or through the Platform's messaging features.

4. Why We Process Your Information

We process personal information to: operate and improve the Platform; create and manage accounts; facilitate Engagements between Clients and Professionals; process payments; verify Professional credentials; communicate with Users; comply with legal and tax obligations; and detect and prevent fraud.

Our lawful basis for processing is, depending on the activity: performance of a contract with the User, the User's consent, compliance with a legal obligation, or Designlynk's legitimate business interest in operating a safe and functional marketplace.

5. Sharing of Information

We share personal information with:

- Other Users, where necessary to facilitate an Engagement (e.g. a Client sees a Professional's profile and portfolio; a Professional sees a Client's project brief and contact details once an Engagement is agreed);
- Stripe, for payment processing, in line with Stripe's own privacy policy;
- Service providers who support the Platform (e.g. hosting, analytics), under confidentiality obligations;
- Regulators or authorities, where required by law.

We do not sell personal information to third parties.

6. Cross-Border Transfers

Because Designlynk serves Clients and Professionals across African countries, and because Stripe processes payments internationally, personal information may be transferred outside South Africa. Where this occurs, we take reasonable steps to ensure the receiving party is subject to a level of protection substantially similar to POPIA, as required by section 72 of POPIA.

7. Data Retention

We retain personal information for as long as a User's account is active, and thereafter for as long as necessary to comply with legal, tax, or accounting obligations, or to resolve disputes.

8. Security

We take reasonable technical and organisational measures to protect personal information against loss, unauthorised access, and misuse, appropriate to the nature of the information

involved.

9. Your Rights

Subject to POPIA, you have the right to:

- Request access to the personal information we hold about you;
- Request correction of inaccurate or outdated information;
- Request deletion of your personal information, subject to any legal obligation we have to retain it;
- Object to processing carried out on the basis of legitimate interest;
- Withdraw consent where processing is based on consent, without affecting processing already carried out;
- Lodge a complaint with the Information Regulator if you believe your information has been processed unlawfully.

Requests can be directed to our Information Officer using the contact details above.

10. Cookies and Similar Technologies

The Platform may use cookies or similar technologies to keep you logged in, remember preferences, and understand how the Platform is used. You can control cookies through your browser settings.

11. Children

The Platform is not directed at, and is not intended for use by, individuals under the age of 18.

12. Changes to This Policy

We may update this Privacy Policy from time to time. Material changes will be communicated to Users through the Platform.

13. Contact and Complaints

Questions or requests relating to this Policy can be directed to our Information Officer at privacy@designlynk.co.za.

You may also contact the Information Regulator of South Africa: complaints.IR@justice.gov.za.

